



U.S.M.C. MINISTRIES

Uniting, Serving, Mentoring and Counseling Ministries

The Diffusion Curve & Discipleship Strategy

Preach Broadly. Disciple Selectively.

A U.S.M.C. Ministries Point Paper · Prepared by Adam “MOOP” Johns

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The same curve that explains how a technology spreads explains how discipleship takes root. Everett Rogers’ *Diffusion of Innovations* sorts any population into five groups — innovators, early adopters, the early majority, the late majority, and laggards. Geoffrey Moore named the deadly gap between the visionaries and the pragmatists *the chasm*. Applied to men’s ministry the lesson is ancient: preach the gospel to every man without filter, but invest finite discipleship hours in the ready — the roughly fifteen percent who become multipliers. This is not elitism. It is the pattern of Christ, who taught the multitudes and disciplined twelve. What follows is the framework, its biblical foundation, and how U.S.M.C. Ministries and its partner network apply it — beginning in the home.

THE FRAMEWORK

Everett Rogers first mapped how new ideas move through a population in 1962; Geoffrey Moore sharpened it for the modern market in 1991.^{1 2} The shares below are fixed by the model and have held across thousands of studies.³ The categories are not about worth — they are about readiness.

Segment	Share	Posture
Innovators	2.5%	Build it; tolerate breakage. Driven by the thing itself.
Early Adopters	13.5%	Adopt for advantage. Visionaries, comfortable with rough edges.
Early Majority	34%	Pragmatists. Will not move without references, standards, and proof.
Late Majority	34%	Conservatives. Move only when not moving costs more than moving.
Laggards	16%	Skeptics. Move only under compulsion or when alternatives vanish.

Moore’s contribution was to name *the chasm* — the gap between the early adopters and the early majority where most efforts die. Visionaries tolerate rough edges; pragmatists do not. They demand a finished product, peer validation, and proof before they move. Most programs fail because they try to cross that gap by watering down what made them work.

THE BIBLICAL FOUNDATION

This is not a corporate curve laid over Scripture. It is the Parable of the Sower expressed as percentages. In [Matthew 13](#) the same seed meets four soils and yields four results; Christ named the disparity plainly and kept sowing.⁴ In [Luke 10](#) the seventy are sent to find the “son of peace” in each town — a readiness filter, not a rejection of the lost.⁵ In [Matthew 7:6](#) He warns against casting pearls before swine — sacred things are allocated.⁶ In [Acts 13:46](#) Paul and Barnabas, once rejected, turn their effort toward receptive soil.⁷ And in [2 Timothy 2:2](#) Paul tells Timothy to commit the deposit to faithful men who will teach others also.⁸ The Great Commission is universal in scope and selective in depth. Christ preached to thousands and disciplined twelve. Confusing the two has wrecked more men’s ministries than any scandal.

THE OPERATIONAL APPLICATION

Translated into how a ministry actually spends its hours, the curve yields five disciplines:

- **Design cohorts for the hungry, not the hesitant.** A group built to appeal to the late majority gets softened until the men who needed the hard call disengage.
- **Stack the first cohorts with innovators and early adopters.** They become the testimony that draws the early majority into cohort three.
- **Measure multipliers, not enrollment.** In year one, success is men who can lead the next cohort — not heads in seats.
- **Filter with your language.** “For the man who knows he needs to fight” lets the wrong men self-exclude. That is the point, not a failure.
- **Keep the pulpit open to every man.** The curve governs where structured hours go — never whether the gospel is preached.

INSIDE THE HOME — THE FAMILY CAPTAIN

The first discipleship cohort is not a church program; it is the household. Every father is the family captain — the man standing watch over his home. U.S.M.C. Ministries frames that home through the **TACC** construct: the **Temporary Abode for Character Cultivation** — a modification of John Michael Clark’s original framework.⁹ The home is a station held on loan, a mission field where character is forged before it is deployed. The husband stands as senior watch officer, the wife as senior administrator, and the children carry operational roles fitted to their season. Discipleship that cannot survive contact with one’s own kitchen table will not survive a cohort. Start there.

BROTHERHOOD ACROSS THE CURVE

No single ministry reaches every soil, and none should try. Across the network, each ministry is calibrated to a different segment. [Spotswood Baptist Church](#) pairs broad proclamation from the pulpit with a structured Freedom Group for the ready. [Proven Men Ministries](#) disciples men toward sexual integrity — calibrated to innovators and *early adopter* men already aware of the fight. [Noble Warriors](#) runs retreats and rites of passage that move men across the chasm. [Men of Valor International](#) trains leaders and multiplies mentors across nations. [CBMC](#) reaches men in the marketplace where they already work. And [Tun Tavern Fellowship](#) is a veteran brotherhood for active duty and prior service Marines, named for the 1775 Philadelphia tavern where the Corps was born. Together they cover ground no single program could.

SUSTAINABILITY

The model is durable because it refuses to spend scarce energy where it yields least. Discipleship hours are the limiting resource; spent on the ready, they produce multipliers, and multipliers — not the founder — carry the next cohort. [2 Timothy 2:2](#) is a sustainability doctrine: what you commit to faithful men, they teach others also. A ministry that measures multipliers compounds. One that measures attendance plateaus and burns out its leaders. Preach broadly; disciple selectively; multiply relentlessly.

TAKEAWAYS

- **Evangelism is universal; discipleship is allocated.** Keep the door open to every man; spend structured hours on the ready.
- **Build for the hungry.** Programs softened for the reluctant lose the multipliers who needed the hard call.
- **The home is the first cohort.** A man who will not disciple at his own table will not disciple anywhere.
- **Watch the elder-brother trap.** Being early is no ground for contempt; today’s laggard may be tomorrow’s innovator when crisis hits.
- **Measure multipliers.** Faithful men who teach others are the only metric that compounds.

ENDNOTES & REFERENCES

- ¹ Everett M. Rogers, *Diffusion of Innovations*, 5th ed. (New York: Free Press, 2003); first published 1962.
- ² Geoffrey A. Moore, *Crossing the Chasm* (New York: HarperBusiness, 1991; rev. 2014).
- ³ Adoption shares per Rogers: Innovators 2.5%, Early Adopters 13.5%, Early Majority 34%, Late Majority 34%, Laggards 16%.
- ⁴ Matthew 13:1-23 — the Parable of the Sower (the four soils), NKJV.
- ⁵ Luke 10:1-11 — the seventy sent out; the “son of peace,” v. 6, NKJV.
- ⁶ Matthew 7:6 — “Do not give what is holy to the dogs... nor cast your pearls before swine,” NKJV.
- ⁷ Acts 13:46 — Paul and Barnabas turn to receptive hearers after rejection, NKJV.
- ⁸ 2 Timothy 2:2 — “commit these to faithful men who will be able to teach others also,” NKJV.
- ⁹ TACC — *Temporary Abode for Character Cultivation*: Adam “MOOP” Johns’ modification of the original family-leadership construct by John Michael Clark.

MINISTRY NETWORK

- Spotswood Baptist Church — spotswood.org
- Proven Men Ministries — provenmen.org
- Noble Warriors (Mike Young, founder, 2005) — noblewarriors.org
- Men of Valor International (Brad Smith, founder) — menofvalor.org
- CBMC — cbmc.com
- Tun Tavern Fellowship — Crossroads Presbyterian Church auxiliary (Woodbridge, VA); led by Mike West, LtCol USMC (Ret.), Director — tuntavernfellowship.org

Bible references link to the MOOP Bible Translation Engine V5.0 at usmcmmin.org/bible.html.